

AI-powered platform designed for emotional health and well-being, Twill is accessible round the clock via a mobile app and a web platform. The tool empowers employees to combat stress and discover inner calm.

Amazon realises that to scale up, it needs to attract and retain more talent. And this is not easy. But the company has come up with various programmes, like Amazon Future Engineer (AFE), through which it reaches out to find the right talent from the remotest of places. AFE, in fact, hits two birds at one go. A comprehensive childhood-to-career scheme aimed at increasing access to computer science education for students from underserved communities, the AFE programme has managed to discover for Amazon some of its talents from the hinterlands. The programme has already helped more than 1.5 million students explore and learn computer science across more than 10,000 schools in India. The tech behemoth also has a programme only for women, called Amazon Women of the World, which is designed to empower and equip women students enrolled in engineering colleges across India with essential skills to thrive in the technology industry. Meant for freshers who could not secure a job at Amazon through campus placement, this programme offers them a shot at the vacancies.

Fostering diversity, particularly by empowering women within the organisation, represents a key objective for any progressive employer, and Amazon is not an exception. However, for Amazon, diversity transcends mere gender representation. "Diversity extends far beyond gender," asserts Varma. "It's about cultivating a spectrum



### Key HR initiatives

▶ **Amazon has MyHR, a one-stop solution for all employee-related inquiries**

▶ **It also has a Wiki site, which serves as a portal dedicated to cataloguing comprehensive**

**information about Amazon for employees**

▶ **For those seeking help related to mental health, Amazon's Twill can come in handy. Being AI-powered, it is designed for emotional well-being**

▶ **Its 'rekindle' is an initiative to provide a launch pad to women who have taken a break in their careers**

▶ **It also has a programme that benefits women engineering students**

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of skill sets, experiences, and backgrounds." Yet, she emphasises that merit remains paramount as well for securing a place here, underscoring the importance of competence to exist alongside diversity.

Recognising the significance of succession planning in large organisations, Varma spearheads the newly launched 'Power of 10' programme. This initiative places aspiring women leaders in cohorts of 10, facilitating invaluable exchanges with senior leadership. Through these interactions, participants delve into topics spanning career growth and leadership skills,

fostering a culture of continuous learning and development.

But what drives Amazon's employees? Varma believes it is the culture of encouraging innovation and fostering risk-taking abilities. In fact, that is the reason why Varma and her colleagues define the HR division as the 'people, experience and technology' team. The focus is to use technology to not only improve customers' experiences, but also to make Amazon a space that nurtures and builds. **BT**

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